

STORY / MEMBERS / DESIGN

The Cryptic Bureau

A family tradition, delivered in puzzles.

Cooperative puzzle adventures sent as mysterious family packages. Each box stands alone; every dispatch belongs to a larger family story.

HOW IT BEGAN

Grandma founded the Bureau while working as a spy for Canada. Sent to Cambridge in the UK to learn more about Alan Turing's work, she discovered a fascination with puzzles and history. She began sending puzzles to her family back in Canada. Unable to use her own name, she signed her packages "The Cryptic Bureau."

After retiring from the spy agency, she travelled as a pilot. Wherever she went, she learned more about history and puzzles, and continued sending packages under the Bureau's name.

Her husband, her children and much of the family carried on the tradition. Sending a puzzle package became a family ritual: an invitation to take part, followed by acceptance into the Bureau. What began as Grandma's secret signature became something the family shared.

THE FAMILY RITUAL

Receive a package. Explore its puzzles.
Become part of the Bureau. Pass the tradition on.

THE MEMBERS

Grandma
Founder, former Canadian spy and travelling pilot.

Her husband
Continued the package-sending tradition.

Aunt Liv
Sends The Raven Inheritance.

Coach
Sends the hockey adventure.

The retired parents
Send the Canada adventure.

The folklore relative
Sends the druid / folklore adventure.

You
A package recipient invited to join the Bureau.

THE ARCHIVE IDENTITY

An envelope and keyhole, with CRYPTIC and BUREAU tucked into the light flap seams. A mark for letters, packages and the family's shared seal.

Burgundy	Ivory	Copper
#542C3B	#F4EBDD	#B87650

Cormorant Garamond Semibold

Display and wordmark / Source Sans 3 for supporting text

Mysterious, playful and personal. Reusable games; no locks or app required. Optional hints are available online.

Member names and family links remain open. Logo shown is the approved raster concept.